Example Methodist Hospital

Financial Assistance Policy

Effective date: July 1, 2025

1. Purpose

Example Methodist Hospital is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Methodist Hospital.

This Policy does not cover cosmetic procedures and retail pharmacy purchases.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in Appendix B, Covered and Non-Covered Providers, posted at https://www.examplemethodist.example/fap/providers.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient, the patient's spouse, and any dependents claimed on the household's federal tax return.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the Federal Poverty Guidelines in effect on the date the application is received.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 400% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 200% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 200% and at or below 400% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines will not be charged more than amounts generally billed.

2025 Federal Poverty Guidelines income limits (annual household income):

Household size	100%	200%	400%
1	$15,650	$31,300	$62,600
2	$21,150	$42,300	$84,600
3	$26,650	$53,300	$106,600
4	$32,150	$64,300	$128,600
5	$37,650	$75,300	$150,600
6	$43,150	$86,300	$172,600
7	$48,650	$97,300	$194,600
8	$54,150	$108,300	$216,600

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. Patients whose household liquid assets exceed $10,000 are not eligible for free or discounted care. Liquid assets include checking accounts, savings accounts, and investments. The following assets are not counted: primary residence, one vehicle per adult, and retirement accounts.

5.2 Residency. To qualify, patients must reside in one of the following Texas counties: Bexar, Atascosa, Comal, Guadalupe, Kendall, or Medina. The residency requirement does not apply to emergency care.

5.3 Insurance. Insured patients are eligible for assistance with deductibles, co-insurance and other balances after insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients are not required to apply for Medicaid before receiving a financial assistance determination.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) the two most recent pay stubs for each working household member;

(b) two months of bank statements for all checking and savings accounts;

(c) a government-issued photo identification;

(d) a Medicaid denial letter, if one has been issued;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Financial Assistance Office, 7700 Medical Example Drive, San Antonio, TX 78229.

- By fax to (210) 555-0199.

- In person at Patient Financial Services, first floor, Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. to 5 p.m..

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 6 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicare fee-for-service and all private health insurers. The current AGB percentage is 31.5% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital does not make presumptive eligibility determinations; an application is required.

7.3 Screening. The Hospital screens patients for financial assistance after billing and before referring any account to collections.

7.4 Refunds. If a patient is approved for financial assistance, the Hospital will refund any amount the patient paid that exceeds the amount the patient owes under this Policy, if the excess is $5 or more.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (210) 555-0100 or write to Financial Assistance Office, 7700 Medical Example Drive, San Antonio, TX 78229.